Yedam Lee

UX & Product Designer

Toronto, ON (open to relocation) | ylee862ylee@gmail.com | 519-697-0827 | ylee862.github.io/portfolio | linkedin.com/in/yedam-lee

EXPERIENCE

University of Western Ontario | Student well-being app team May 2025 - Jun 2026 (Remote)

UX-Embedded Developer *Aug 2025 - Jun 2026*

- Coded most of the backend for the student well-being app on a 3-person team in Python and MongoDB, building every API endpoint the designed screens depended on, then handed it off to a senior developer to add the AI reflection chatbot students asked for in testing.
- Kept the build matched to the approved UX flows over 10 months, translating screen designs into code with 2 other developers and reviewing progress weekly with senior developers and a senior UX designer.

UX Researcher & Designer, USRI Research Program *May 2025 - Aug 2025*

- Redirected the app from sleep tracking to 3 research-backed competencies (emotion regulation, resilience, social support) after a literature review and a competitive scan of 3 apps (Headspace, BetterHelp, I Am Sober), dropping a finished sitemap once the evidence pointed elsewhere.
- Designed 100+ mobile screens, from personas, journey maps, and user flows to wireframes and high-fidelity Figma prototypes, including a self-assessment that finds a student's weakest competency and a guided path to build it.
- Ran pre-survey, think-aloud, and post-survey sessions with 18 students and sorted the findings into confusion points, what worked, and what to change; 72% (13 of 18) said the reflection experience would support their daily well-being, and the findings led to 3 design changes.
- When a participant said the app had "lost its purpose", proposed narrowing scope to the competency features; after team discussion, sleep tracking was postponed to a later version and I redesigned the main screen around competency level, goals, and challenges.
- Built a style guide (colour, type, icons) from the senior designer's palette and icon set to keep 100+ screens consistent, and presented the final prototype at a research conference.

PROJECTS

Fitoday | Outfit Diary App (iOS), Solo Product | In App Store Review Jun 2026 - Present

- Confirmed a gap in outfit feedback tools with a 12-person survey and a review of 4 platforms, and wrote the PRD before any wireframe.
- Designed about 100 screens across 8 flows, including empty, error, and offline states, on a library of about 30 reusable Figma components (Auto Layout, Variants); in 2 rounds of think-aloud testing with 5 participants, all 5 understood the rating with no explanation.
- Caught a cold-start problem before writing code (a score needing 5 ratings would leave new users with nothing back) and pivoted the core to a private outfit diary that works with zero followers, keeping rating as an optional feature, so the cost was a PRD rewrite instead of a rebuilt app.
- Ran 2 rounds of AI-simulated usability walkthroughs (8 personas, 5 tasks each) that cut task failures from 6 to 3 and critical or high issues from 8 to 3 (both predicted, so real-user testing is next); the Expo + Supabase app is now in App Store review.

HiHello | Digital Letter Web App, Solo | Live Aug 2026

- Took a responsive web app from Figma to a live Cloudflare deployment in 5 weeks, designing 20+ screens and 6 postcard styles and using Claude Code for front-end implementation while making every interaction and layout decision myself.
- Designed friction on purpose (a two-photo limit, a "seal it" action that locks editing, and a 5-day wait before the letter opens); 2 of the 3 friends who wrote letters said they put more thought into them, and since the wait is untested, I scoped an A/B test of 24-hour, 5-day, and 14-day delays.

Wordtropolis | Gamified Spelling Game for Kids, HCI Course Project Apr 2026

- Set the visual direction for a 6-person team and built the first mission as the template that kept screens from 5 builders consistent; the playable Java Swing game earned 98%.

SKILLS

Design: Figma (Auto Layout, Components, Variants, Variables, Prototyping), interaction design, user flows, wireframes, design systems
Research: usability testing (in-person and AI-simulated), think-aloud, interviews, surveys, competitive analysis, personas, journey maps
Product: PRD writing, scoping and prioritization, design reviews with engineering, presenting design rationale
Tools: Claude Code, ChatGPT, Jira, Slack, Microsoft Teams, Adobe Photoshop **Languages:** English, Korean
Development: Python, MongoDB, FastAPI, React, JavaScript, HTML, CSS, Java, React Native (Expo), Supabase

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science, Computer Science (Specialization) | University of Western Ontario Jun 2026